

Littleleaf Linden

Tilia cordata



Origin

Native to Europe and western Asia, long planted along grand boulevards -- Berlin's famous street 'Unter den Linden' is named after this tree.

Look for

The fruit hangs from a pale, papery bract that acts like a wing, letting the wind spin the whole cluster away from the parent tree -- look up in late summer to spot them.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Leaf: small, uneven heart shape on a neat, pyramidal crown.
- Flower: fragrant pale yellow clusters bloom in late June, buzzing with bees.
- Fruit: hangs from a pale, papery wing-shaped bract that spins in the wind.
- Commonly confused with: American linden (littleleaf linden's leaves and overall size are noticeably smaller).

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Small, uneven heart-shaped leaves emerge on a neat pyramidal crown.
Summer	Fragrant pale yellow flower clusters bloom in late June, buzzing with bees.
Fall	Leaves turn a soft yellow.
Winter	Small, round winter buds and pale seed-carrying wings may still hang on.

DID YOU KNOW

- Its flowers are one of the most important late-season nectar sources for city bees, and linden honey is prized for its distinct minty-floral flavor.
- European lindens have been planted as shade and ceremonial trees for over 500 years -- many European town squares are still centered on one.